

SnowPro Advanced: Administrator — Prep Guide

PJ's Academy · Prove you can run Snowflake at enterprise scale.

The Administrator exam (ADA-C01) validates that you can manage accounts, security, cost, performance, and data protection across an organization's Snowflake estate.

Prerequisite: SnowPro Core certified.

Exam At A Glance

Item	Detail
Exam code	ADA-C01
Questions	~65
Duration	115 minutes
Cost	\$375 USD
Prerequisite	SnowPro Core

Domain Weightings

#	Domain	Weight
1	Snowflake Security & Governance	30%
2	Account Management & Data Governance	25%
3	Performance & Cost Management	25%
4	Data Protection, DR & Sharing	20%

Domain 1 — Security & Governance (30%)

- **RBAC administration** — role hierarchies, functional vs access roles, `MANAGE GRANTS`, future grants.
- **User & session management** — `CREATE USER`, session policies, session timeouts.
- **Authentication** — SSO/SAML, SCIM provisioning, MFA enforcement, key-pair rotation.
- **Network security** — network policies, network rules, PrivateLink.
- **Governance** — masking policies, row access policies, tags, tag-based masking, object dependencies.
- **ACCESS_HISTORY** & **LOGIN_HISTORY** for auditing.

```
-- Future grants: auto-grant on new objects in a schema
GRANT SELECT ON FUTURE TABLES IN SCHEMA analytics.public TO ROLE reporter;
```

```
-- Session policy
CREATE SESSION POLICY strict_policy SESSION_IDLE_TIMEOUT_MINS = 30;
```

Domain 2 — Account Management & Data Governance (25%)

- **Organizations** — ORGADMIN, creating accounts, cross-region/cloud.
- **Resource monitors** — org & account level, credit quotas, triggers.
- **Parameters** — account/session/object parameter hierarchy.
- **ACCOUNT_USAGE** vs **ORGANIZATION_USAGE** schemas.
- **Replication & data governance** across accounts.

Domain 3 — Performance & Cost Management (25%)

- **Warehouse administration** — sizing, multi-cluster scaling policies (Standard vs Economy), auto-suspend/resume.
- **Cost attribution** — chargeback via ACCOUNT_USAGE, resource monitors, budgets.
- **Query performance** — Query Profile, clustering, search optimization, materialized views.
- **Warehouse utilization** — `WAREHOUSE_LOAD_HISTORY`, queuing, spilling.
- **Storage cost** — Time Travel/Fail-safe retention, transient tables.

```
-- Find idle-but-expensive warehouses
SELECT warehouse_name, SUM(credits_used) c
FROM SNOWFLAKE.ACCOUNT_USAGE.WAREHOUSE_METERING_HISTORY
WHERE start_time > DATEADD(day, -30, CURRENT_DATE())
GROUP BY 1 ORDER BY c DESC;
```

Domain 4 — Data Protection, DR & Sharing (20%)

- **Time Travel & Fail-safe** administration, retention tuning.
- **Replication & failover groups** — DR design, RPO/RTO.
- **Cloning** for backup/dev strategies.
- **Secure Data Sharing** administration — shares, reader accounts, Data Exchange.
- **Encryption** — key rotation, Tri-Secret Secure, customer-managed keys.

High-Yield Facts

- **Future grants** auto-apply privileges to objects created later — key admin tool.
- **Economy** scaling policy conserves credits (fuller clusters) vs **Standard** (faster).
- **ORGADMIN** manages the organization & creates accounts.
- **ORGANIZATION_USAGE** aggregates usage across all accounts.
- **Resource monitors** can act at account OR warehouse level with NOTIFY/SUSPEND triggers.
- **Session policies** enforce idle timeouts; **network policies** restrict IPs.

Practice Questions (10)

Q1. Which auto-grants privileges on objects created later in a schema? A) GRANT ... ON ALL B) GRANT ... ON FUTURE C) MANAGE GRANTS D) ROLE inheritance

Q2. Which scaling policy conserves credits by filling clusters? A) Standard B) Economy C) Auto D) Maximized

- Q3.** Which role manages the organization and creates accounts? A) ACCOUNTADMIN B) ORGADMIN C) SECURITYADMIN D) SYSADMIN
- Q4.** Cross-account usage is aggregated in: A) ACCOUNT_USAGE B) ORGANIZATION_USAGE C) INFORMATION_SCHEMA D) PUBLIC
- Q5.** A resource monitor can act at which levels? A) Account only B) Warehouse only C) Account and warehouse D) Query only
- Q6.** Which view audits who accessed which columns? A) LOGIN_HISTORY B) ACCESS_HISTORY C) QUERY_HISTORY D) COPY_HISTORY
- Q7.** For non-Snowflake data consumers, admins create: A) A share only B) A reader account C) A clone D) A stage
- Q8.** Which enforces a 30-minute idle logout? A) Network policy B) Session policy C) Masking policy D) Row policy
- Q9.** To restrict access to specific IP ranges: A) Session policy B) Network policy C) Masking D) Tag
- Q10.** Replicating account objects for DR uses: A) Replication group B) Failover group C) Clone D) Share

✓ **Answers**

1-B · 2-B · 3-B · 4-B · 5-C · 6-B · 7-B · 8-B · 9-B · 10-B



3-Week Plan

- **Week 1:** Security & governance (RBAC, policies, auditing).
- **Week 2:** Account mgmt + performance/cost.
- **Week 3:** DR/sharing + practice tests.

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